# Strait of Hormuz Crisis

Oil Supply Disruption Briefing — **March 19, 2026 (Day 20)** — Last refreshed: Mar 19, 7:01 AM MDT — Ras Tanura restarts after 16-day outage; Ras Laffan struck by second ballistic missile (Mar 18) — "extensive damage" to Pearl GTL + LNG units; Qatar expels Iranian military attachés; Brent $113.10 (+5.3% on day); Wood Mackenzie: Ras Laffan attacks "fundamentally reshape global LNG outlook"

**Data freshness:** LIVE Daily market price — verify before trading POLICY Government action — check for updates STRUCTURAL Infrastructure / historical — stable

**-12.0 mb/d** net global oil shortage (temporarily improved by GL 134 waiver; **reverts to ~-13.2 after Apr 11**).

The US-Israel war on Iran (Feb 28) triggered the largest oil supply disruption in the history of the global oil market,[7] taking ~20 mb/d offline — roughly 20% of global supply.[1] Iran is not enforcing a total closure. It is running a **selective blockade**, blocking Western-allied ships while granting permission-based passage to Indian, Turkish, Pakistani, and China-bound vessels.[5]

Brent LIVE spiked to **$119.11/bbl intraday** on Mar 19 before settling near $113; US diesel LIVE $5.07/gal national avg (AAA, Mar 19).[64] [24] [75] The IEA's record 400M bbl SPR release has failed to push prices below $100; first physical barrels are expected to reach market Mar 19.[9] The GL 134 Russian oil waiver covering 186M bbl of floating inventory expires Apr 11 with no extension signals — a second supply cliff is approaching.[3]

On the military and diplomatic front, US/Israel struck South Pars gas field on Mar 18, taking four gas treatment facilities (phases 3–6) offline and damaging the Tehran refinery (220K b/d).[42] Iran killed intelligence minister Khatib in retaliation and vowed to escalate "in new ways," with the IRGC naming five Gulf energy targets "to be struck within hours."[18] [49] Over 40 Iranian officials have been killed to date. Germany, Japan, Italy, Romania, Spain, UK, and Australia declined Trump's escort coalition request,[15] while Iran FM Araghchi proposed a post-war **Hormuz Strait protocol** — framing permanent Iranian control as an institutional lever, not just a wartime tactic.[19] Mojtaba Khamenei (new Supreme Leader) and the FM have both rejected ceasefire.

The most significant development of the past 48 hours is the **destruction of Qatar's Ras Laffan complex** in two separate attack waves. Iran struck Pearl GTL (Mar 18 PM) and LNG trains S4+S6 (Mar 19 AM predawn), wiping out 17% of Qatar's LNG capacity for up to five years — 12.8 mtpa offline, $20B in annual revenue lost, $26B in infrastructure destroyed.[61] [62] [78] Qatar responded by expelling Iran's military and security attachés and invoking Article 51 of the UN Charter. Wood Mackenzie called it a fundamental reshaping of the global LNG outlook.[63] [67] On a more positive note, Ras Tanura (Saudi Arabia) restarted on Mar 19 after a 16-day outage — the longest since 1990.[60]

| -20.0 mb/d | +8.05 mb/d | -12.0 mb/d | $113 /bbl |
|---|---|---|---|
| HORMUZ TRANSIT LOST | MITIGATIONS (THRU APR 11) | NET SHORTAGE | BRENT CRUDE<br>*Mar 19, 7:01 AM MDT* |
| **$98.91 /bbl** | **$153.12 /bbl** | **$1,133 /t** | **$5.07 /gal** |
| WTI CRUDE<br>*Mar 19, intraday* | OMAN CRUDE (DME)<br>*Mar 17–18 close* | ICE LOW SULPHUR GASOIL<br>*Mar 19, intraday* | US DIESEL<br>*Mar 19, AAA national avg* |

| Mar 28 | Apr 11 | ~Jul 10 |
|---|---|---|
| 4-week shut-in threshold<br>Permanent well damage risk (water coning) | GL 134 expires<br>−2 mb/d cliff (no extension signals) | US SPR exhausted<br>172M bbl at 1.43 mb/d |

## Timeline of Key Events

**INFRASTRUCTURE DAMAGE**

**Mar 19 AM** Iran fires **second missile wave at Ras Laffan** (predawn); directly strikes **LNG trains S4 + S6**; fires break out and are contained within hours; no casualties. Combined with Mar 18 Pearl GTL hit: **2 of 14 LNG trains destroyed + Pearl GTL offline** — QatarEnergy CEO: *"wipes out 17% of Qatar's LNG capacity for up to five years"*; 12.8 mtpa offline; $20B annual revenue lost; condensate –24%, helium –14%, LPG –13%; $26B in infrastructure build cost destroyed.[77] [78] [79]

**Mar 19** **Ras Tanura (Saudi Arabia) restarts** after 16-day outage — longest shutdown since 1990; exports rerouted via Red Sea coast.[60] Iran strikes **SAMREF refinery, Yanbu** (Saudi Aramco/ExxonMobil JV) — "minimal damage"; Yanbu is primary Hormuz-bypass export route.[72] Drone hits **Mina Al-Ahmadi refinery (Kuwait)**, 730K bpd capacity — limited fire, no injuries.[73]

**Mar 18 PM** US/Israel strike **South Pars / Assaluyeh** — four gas treatment plants (phases 3–6) taken offline (~3.1 bcf/d, ~12% of Iran's gas output); Iran-Iraq gas pipeline halted → 3,100 MW of Iraqi grid offline; Tehran refinery (220K b/d) also damaged; bunker-buster bombs on hardened Iranian missile sites near strait.[42] Iran fires 5 ballistic missiles at **Ras Laffan**; 4 intercepted, **1 hits Pearl GTL complex** (Shell/QatarEnergy JV, 140K bbl/d GTL products); fires break out; critical air separation units likely destroyed — multi-year rebuild expected; Shell halts all Pearl GTL production.[61] [62]

**Mar 16** Drone strike sets **Shah Gas Field** (ADNOC/Occidental JV, Abu Dhabi) ablaze — 1.28 bcf/d capacity offline; supplies ~20% of UAE total gas and ~5% of global granulated sulphur.[69] Fujairah Oil Terminal struck again (3rd impact); separate tanker attacked at anchorage ~23 nm east of Fujairah (UKMTO advisory).[38]

**Mar 14** Fujairah Oil Terminal — first *direct* terminal strike: 2 crude storage tanks hit, 2M bbl affected, loadings suspended (resumed Mar 15).[38] US strikes 90+ military targets on Kharg Island — oil terminal deliberately spared; 8+ tankers (~14M bbl) continue loading unimpeded.[30]

**Mar 10** Drone strikes **Ruwais Refinery Complex** (ADNOC, Abu Dhabi) — fire inside complex; full 922K bpd capacity halted; 417K b/d crude distillation unit confirmed offline.[70]

**Mar 9** Drone strike on **Sitra Refinery** (Bapco Energies, Bahrain) — Bapco declares force majeure on all shipments; 405K bpd offline; 32 nearby civilians injured.[71]

**Mar 7** Kuwait declares force majeure; combined Gulf crude offline reaches ~6.7 mb/d; **first VLCC loading at Jask terminal since Oct 2024** (~2M bbl — only 5th Jask loading in 5 years).[44] [10]

**▶ MILITARY · DIPLOMATIC · FINANCIAL**

**Mar 19** **Qatar expels Iranian military and security attachés**, invokes **Article 51 UN Charter** (self-defense); orders Iranian officials out within 24 hours; warns of "further measures."[63] Brent spikes to **$119.11/bbl intraday** (first time above $115 since 2022) before settling at ~$113.71; US AAA gasoline avg **$3.884/gal** (+32.6% vs. month ago).[64] [65] [75] Al Jazeera analysts: **"$200/bbl no longer far-fetched."**[76] Wood Mackenzie: **"Ras Laffan attacks fundamentally reshape global LNG outlook."**[67] QatarEnergy leasing idle LNG tankers; CEO: no restart until conflict ends completely.[66] Trump threatens to **"massively blow up the entirety of South Pars"** if Iran attacks Qatar again; separately told Netanyahu to halt gas field strikes; Axios confirmed US and Israel **coordinated the original South Pars strike in advance** — Trump's public denial was false.[81] [82] Iran FM: *"We have sent no message and have not requested a ceasefire."*[83] CNN confirms 200+ Israeli targets struck across western/central Iran on Mar 18 (not just Kharg); 20+ total maritime incidents in Hormuz/Gulf since Feb 28.[84]

**Mar 19 AM** **IDF strikes Bandar Anzali (Caspian Sea)** — first Israeli strike on northern Iran (~1,300 km range); destroys 4 Iranian missile ships, 1 corvette, central Navy command center, and repair infrastructure; first hit on the **Iran–Russia Caspian resupply lifeline**.[80]

**Mar 18 PM** Brent +6.1% to $109.75 intraday; TTF gas +9.1%.[23] Israel kills intelligence minister Khatib — confirmed by President Pezeshkian.[18] Iran vows to escalate "in new ways"; IRGC names five Gulf energy targets: SAMREF Yanbu (400K b/d), Sadara Jubail, Qatar Chemical, Ras Laffan refinery (305K b/d), Al-Hosn gasfield UAE (1 bcf/d).[49]

**Mar 18 AM** Iran FM Araghchi proposes regional Hormuz Strait protocol post-war; France and Italy contact Iran directly; Iran "open to countries who want to talk"; vessel traffic nearly doubles — 8 non-Iranian ships detected (Windward AI).[19] [59]

**Mar 17** Ali Larijani (Security Chief) + Gholamreza Soleimani (Basij Commander) killed by Israeli strikes; 40+ Iranian officials killed in total; Germany, Japan, Italy, Romania, Spain, UK, Australia formally decline escort coalition; Trump threatens NATO exit over refusal to secure Hormuz.[16] [15]

**Mar 15–16** Pakistani tanker *KARACHI* transits with AIS active; Saudi tanker (1M bbl for India) allowed through; Jask loading resumes; **Khamenei first public statement**: "Strait must be used as leverage" — rejects ceasefire from 2 intermediary states; Iran FM: "we never asked for a ceasefire."[5] [10] [19]

**Mar 6** First Qatar LNG cargo (Al Ghashamiya) loaded at Ras Laffan since force majeure — partial resumption only; structural damage from Mar 18 second strike later renders this temporary restart moot.[33]

**Mar 3** Fujairah port — drone interception debris causes minor fire; first impact on facility (operations not halted).[4] Iraq shuts Rumaila oilfield (precautionary; storage full); combined Gulf production cuts reach ~5.9 mb/d.[44] Port of Duqm (Oman) fuel tank explosion; Salalah port fire.[4]

**Mar 2** Iran's retaliation wave: drone directly hits **Ras Laffan Industrial City** (QatarEnergy facility) — all LNG production halted; ~80 MTPA (~20% of global LNG supply) offline; force majeure declared; European gas +50%, Asian LNG benchmark +39%.[33] **Ras Tanura refinery** (Saudi Arabia) — drone debris fire; precautionary halt begins 16-day outage.[60] Mesaieed water plant (Qatar) drone hit; Mussafah fuel terminal (UAE) fire contained; tanker *Athe Nova* struck in Strait of Hormuz — set ablaze, exits to Gulf of Oman.[4]

**Mar 13** Turkish vessel granted first non-Iranian passage; Treasury Sec. Bessent confirms US allowing Iranian and Chinese-flagged tankers through, not Western ones.[5] [13]

**Mar 12** SPR physical releases begin; OFAC issues GL 134 (186M bbl Russian crude waiver, expires Apr 11); Brent holds above $100.[3] [13]

**Mar 11** Saudi activates East-West Pipeline (Yanbu 2.5 mb/d); IEA authorizes record 400M bbl emergency release;[1] UN Security Council Resolution 2817 passes 13-0-2 (China/Russia abstain);[2] Shell declares force majeure on all Qatar LNG contracts — covering EU, South Korea, and China buyers.[74]

**Mar 9** Brent surges past $100/bbl for first time; **Mojtaba Khamenei elected Supreme Leader** (IRGC-backed hardliner); IMO confirms 4 seafarers killed from Mar 2 tanker attacks.[58]

**Mar 5** IRGC formally announces Hormuz closure to US/Israel/Western-allied ships; major P&I clubs cancel war risk cover; Maersk, CMA CGM, Hapag-Lloyd suspend transits.[14] [32]

**Mar 3** Assembly of Experts convenes for Iranian leadership succession.[58]

**Feb 28** US/Israel launch strikes on Iran; Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei killed; "major combat operations" declared.[58]

## Iran's Selective Blockade Strategy

> Iran is **not** enforcing a total closure. It is operating a **selective blockade** — blocking US/Western-allied shipping while allowing passage for strategically useful traffic.[5] This divides the Western coalition (India and China have less incentive to act), maintains Iran's revenue, and turns Hormuz into a diplomatic lever. Traffic has collapsed 95%+ from the pre-war 100+ ships/day.[17]

| ALLOWED THROUGH | DETAILS |
|---|---|
| **Iranian-flagged vessels** | ~1.5 mb/d continuing exports; ~1.25 mb/d reaching China via dark fleet; 11.7M bbl since Feb 28.[10] |
| **India-linked cargoes** | 2 Indian LPG carriers; 1 Saudi tanker (1M bbl for India).[5] |
| **Turkish vessel** | Granted passage Mar 13 — confirmed by Turkish transport minister.[5] |
| **Pakistani tanker** | *KARACHI* transited Mar 15 with AIS active.[59] |
| **China-bound dark fleet** | 11.7M bbl Iranian crude transited since Feb 28, all China-bound.[10] |
| **Jask terminal** | Iran executing crude exports from Kooh Mobarak terminal south of Hormuz, bypassing strait entirely.[10] |

As of Mar 18, vessel transits have nearly doubled to 8 non-Iranian ships detected Monday (MarineTraffic/S&P Global), up from 2–5/day in prior days — "a growing number rerouting via Iran's territorial waters," reflecting permission-based expansion to friendly nations.[19] [17] Iran FM Araghchi: the strait is **"open, but closed to our enemies."**[18]

Iran is reportedly considering allowing **yuan-denominated cargoes** to transit — turning the energy corridor into a currency weapon and challenging petrodollar dynamics.[26]

## Infrastructure Damage by Country

| COUNTRY | FACILITY | TYPE | ATTACK | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Saudi Arabia** | Ras Tanura | Refinery + terminal (550K b/d) | Drone debris Mar 1 | **Restarted Mar 18** — 16-day outage; some exports rerouted via Red Sea coast during shutdown.[60] |
| **Qatar** | Ras Laffan | LNG plant + Pearl GTL (~20% global LNG supply) | Drone strike Mar 2; ballistic missile Mar 18 PM (Pearl GTL); **ballistic missile Mar 19 AM (LNG trains S4+S6)** | Force majeure declared Mar 4; 1 cargo loaded Mar 6; **combined Mar 18+19 strikes: 2 of 14 LNG trains + Pearl GTL destroyed; 17% capacity (12.8 mtpa) offline; 3–5 yr rebuild; $20B annual revenue lost**; CEO: no restart until conflict ends; North Field expansion delayed to 2027.[33] [61] [62] [78] |
| **Qatar** | Mesaieed | Petrochemicals/power | Drone strike Mar 2 | Downstream production halted.[4] |
| **UAE** | Mussafah | Fuel terminal | Direct hit Mar 1 | Fire; assessment ongoing.[4] |
| **UAE** | Fujairah | Oil terminal (key ADCOP exit) | Hit 3 times (Mar 9, 14, 16) | Loading impaired; ADCOP pipeline still flowing at 1.8 mb/d.[8] |
| **Oman** | Duqm | Fuel storage | Multiple drones Mar 1–2 | Direct hit, explosion reported.[4] |
| **Oman** | Salalah | Port | Drone strike | Damage reported.[4] |
| **Iran** | Kharg Island | Oil export hub (~7M b/d capacity) | US strikes Mar 14 (90+ targets) | Military targets only; oil infrastructure spared; 8+ tanker loadings (~14M bbl) continuing.[30] |
| **Iran** | South Pars / Assaluyeh | World's largest gas field (70–75% of Iranian gas production); phases 3–6 onshore processing | US/Israel strikes Mar 18 | 4 gas treatment facilities taken offline; Tehran refinery (220K b/d) also damaged; fire at gasfield brought under control; production volumes not disclosed.[42] [47] |

**Maritime:** 21 confirmed Iranian ship attacks as of Mar 12.[58] Vessel *Athe Nova* (Honduran-flagged) set ablaze near UAE.

**Imminent threats (Mar 18):** Iran's armed forces named five Gulf facilities as "direct and legitimate targets to be struck within hours": SAMREF refinery Yanbu, Saudi Arabia (400K b/d); Sadara petrochemical complex, Jubail; Qatar Chemical, Doha; Ras Laffan refinery (305K b/d); Al-Hosn sour gas field, Abu Dhabi (1 bcf/d).[49]

## Production Cuts (Shut-ins from Storage Constraints)

Global oil supply collapsed to 98.8 mb/d in March vs. ~106 mb/d pre-crisis — a loss of ~7.2 mb/d at the system level.[44] IEA projects global supply down 8 mb/d in March; at least 8 mb/d crude + 2 mb/d condensate/NGL curtailed.[1] [45] Gulf refining capacity shut: 3+ mb/d, freezing 3.3 mb/d of refined product exports and 1.5 mb/d of LPG exports.[1]

| COUNTRY | PRE-CRISIS | CURRENT (EST.) | CUT | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Saudi Arabia** | ~10.5 mb/d | ~8.0–8.5 mb/d | ~2.0–2.5 mb/d | Partially offset by East-West Pipeline (2.5 mb/d Yanbu throughput).[44] |
| **Iraq** | ~4.3 mb/d | ~1.4 mb/d | ~2.9 mb/d | Rumaila shut-in Mar 3 (storage full); largest single-country cut.[44] |
| **Kuwait** | ~2.7 mb/d | ~2.2 mb/d | ~0.5 mb/d | Force majeure declared Mar 7; no pipeline bypass option.[44] |
| **UAE** | ~3.2 mb/d | ~2.4–2.7 mb/d | ~0.5–0.8 mb/d | ADCOP pipeline (1.8 mb/d) providing partial export relief.[8] |
| **Iran** | ~3.2 mb/d | Exporting via own control | Complex | ~1.5 mb/d reaching China through Kharg + Jask terminals.[10] |
| **Total Gulf crude** | **~24 mb/d** | **~98.8 mb/d global** | **~5.9–6.7 mb/d offline** | **IEA: "largest supply disruption in history of the global oil market."**[1] |

## Repair & Restart Timelines

### Physical Damage

- **Ras Tanura: Restarted Mar 18** — 16-day outage (fire damage + equipment inspection). Export routing partially shifted to Red Sea coast during shutdown.[60]
- **Ras Laffan LNG:** QatarEnergy CEO states restart requires complete end of conflict; 2 weeks minimum after ceasefire + 2 weeks to full capacity; North Field expansion delayed to at least 2027.[33]
- **Fujairah:** Hit 3 times; loading impaired but ADCOP pipeline flowing at 1.8 mb/d.[8]
- **South Pars / Assaluyeh:** 4 gas treatment facilities offline (phases 3–6); fire controlled but no production timeline given; Tehran refinery (220K b/d) damaged separately.[42]
- **Others:** Weeks to assess; fuel storage tank replacement 4–8 weeks minimum.[27]

### Shut-in Wells

#### Water Coning Risk

Wells shut >4 weeks face permanent damage. Bottom water rushes into mature reservoirs during extended shut-ins, trapping oil in pore spaces — potentially irreversible formation damage.[7] Wells shut since Mar 3 hit this critical window around **Mar 28**.

- **First 2 weeks:** Restart straightforward (days to a week per well)
- **2–4 weeks idle:** Corrosion begins; inspection and equipment replacement needed
- **Beyond 4 weeks:** Risk of permanent well damage — oil trapped in pore spaces, potentially unrecoverable
- **IEA:** "Upstream production will take weeks and, in some cases, months, to return to pre-crisis levels."[1]

### Strait Reopening Scenarios

- **ING base case:** 4 weeks total (2 full closure + 2 at 50%).
- **Bull case:** Selective passage already occurring; US Navy estimates escort readiness by end of March (needs 8–10 destroyers per convoy).[38]
- **Bear case:** Mojtaba Khamenei hardliner; Iran FM "we never asked for a ceasefire"[6]; South Pars strike risks full-scale energy war — Iranian official warned it "triggers full-scale economic war."[47]

### Post-Reopening Recovery Lag

#### 2–2.5 Months to Steady State

Even after Hormuz reopens, the system does not normalize immediately. Well restarts, pipeline recommissioning, insurance market normalization, and tanker fleet repositioning create a 2–2.5 month lag before Gulf supply returns to pre-crisis levels.[27]

- **Week 1–2:** Selective vessels begin transit; war risk premiums remain elevated (1–2% of hull); tanker fleet repositioning underway
- **Week 2–4:** Well restarts (those not permanently damaged); pipeline recommissioning; port congestion clears
- **Month 2:** Insurance market begins normalizing; more tankers return to route; refinery crude slates rebalance
- **Month 2–2.5:** Supply returns to 80–85% of pre-crisis levels; North Sea, US, Russian substitute barrels begin unwinding
- **Persistent damage:** North Field expansion delayed to 2027[33]; wells damaged by water coning potentially unrecoverable; South Pars phases 3–6 restart timeline unknown.

## Mitigating Factors

### 1. Saudi East-West Pipeline (Petroline) STRUCTURAL

- **Pipe capacity:** 7 mb/d (after NGL line conversion)
- **Yanbu throughput:** ~2.5 mb/d (Sparta Commodities, Mar 16) vs. 750K b/d pre-crisis[44]

- **Net new export:** +1.75 mb/d above pre-crisis baseline[8]
- **Limitation:** Only moves crude — no refined products, LPG, or LNG[8]

### 2. UAE ADCOP Pipeline STRUCTURAL

- **Pipe capacity:** 1.5–1.8 mb/d; now at full capacity[8]
- **Spare activated:** +0.7 mb/d above pre-crisis flow[8]
- **Risk:** Fujairah terminal hit 3 times but pipeline still operational; IRGC now threatening Fujairah area facilities explicitly[49]

### 3. IEA Strategic Petroleum Reserve POLICY

- **Total committed:** 400M bbl — largest coordinated release in IEA's 50-year history[1] [9]
- **Structure:** First tranche is 86M bbl exchange (loan; must be returned with interest)
- **Rate:** ~2.0 mb/d combined (US: 1.43 mb/d over 120 days; IEA non-US: 0.57 mb/d)[1]
- **US SPR capacity:** 714M bbl total; held 415.4M bbl pre-release (peaked at 695M bbl in 2010)[1]
- **OECD government stocks:** ~1.25B bbl total across IEA members[1]
- **Global observed stocks:** ~8,210M bbl (IEA Jan 2026 estimate; highest since early 2021)[44]
- **SPR refill = structural price floor:** 172M bbl committed requires ~$17B in repurchases at $100/bbl — a sustained government buy program supporting prices long after the crisis ends
- **Market reaction:** Flat. Brent held $100+ on announcement day. Insufficient to offset −12 mb/d structural gap.[6]

### 4. GL 134: Russian Oil Waiver (One-Time) POLICY

> **Cliff Risk: Apr 11**
>
> GL 134 is a STOCK, not a FLOW. 186M bbl on ~238 tankers depletes and vanishes after expiration.[3] [44] No extension signals as of Mar 18. This is the single most predictable near-term catalyst for price spikes.

- **OFAC GL 134:** Authorizes delivery of Russian crude already loaded as of Mar 12[3]
- **Effective flow:** ~2.0 mb/d tapering; 60–70M bbl near India/China for prompt delivery[44]
- **Expires:** April 11, 2026 (30 days from issuance)
- **Russia windfall:** Urals swung from −$13/bbl discount to +$4–5/bbl premium (an $18/bbl swing); India's Russian crude imports up ~50% to 1.5 mb/d; Russia earning ~$150M/day additional revenue[44] [52]

### 5. Other Mitigations

- **Russian production:** +0.1 mb/d (minimal; Feb production falling −56K bpd m/m; may cut 300K bpd by April per Rystad)
- **Iranian own exports:** +1.5 mb/d via Kharg + Jask terminals, almost entirely China-bound[10]

### 6. Policy Measures

- **Jones Act waiver:** Under consideration — would allow foreign-flagged tankers to move crude between US ports, freeing Gulf Coast refinery capacity. Politically sensitive (longshore labor opposition); last waived post-Katrina 2005.[28]
- **US crude export ban:** Congressional Democrats proposing emergency ban on US crude exports. Would spike WTI vs. Brent; alienates allies dependent on 2–3 mb/d of US exports; opposed by producers and Treasury.[28]
- **CME Group warning:** Exchange described potential $200+ Brent as a "biblical disaster for the global economy" — prompting review of emergency margin and circuit-breaker protocols.[11]

### Combined Supply Balance

| MITIGATION | VOLUME (MB/D) | START | DURATION |
|---|---|---|---|
| Saudi Pipeline (net) STRUCTURAL | +1.75 | Mar 11 | Indefinite |
| UAE ADCOP spare STRUCTURAL | +0.70 | Mar 1 | Indefinite |
| IEA SPR release POLICY | +2.00 | Mar 12 | ~120 days (US) |
| GL 134 floating inventory POLICY | +2.00 | Mar 12 | Expires Apr 11 |
| Russian increase | +0.10 | Mar 3 | Ongoing |
| Iranian own exports | +1.50 | Ongoing | Ongoing |
| **Total mitigations** | **+8.05** | | |
| **Hormuz transit lost** | **-20.0** | **Feb 28** | **Until reopened** |
| **NET SHORTAGE** | **~-12.0 mb/d** | | |

## Oil Price Impact LIVE

| METRIC | PRE-CRISIS (FEB 27) | CURRENT (MAR 19) | CHANGE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brent Crude | ~$71.00/bbl | $113.10/bbl (Mar 19 AM)[64] | +59% |
| WTI | ~$67.00/bbl | $96.83/bbl[64] | +44% |
| Brent intraday high (Mar 18) | — | $109.75/bbl[42] | +6.1% on Mar 18 |
| Brent intraday peak (all-time crisis) | — | $126/bbl | — |
| US Gasoline (AAA national avg) | $2.92/gal | $3.884/gal[65] | +33% |
| US Diesel (AAA) | $3.65/gal | $5.07/gal[24] | +39% |
| EU diesel (weighted avg) | ~EUR 1.60/L | EUR 2.00/L[46] | +25% |
| European jet fuel crack vs. ICE gasoil | — | $518.5/t (all-time record)[43] | First ever >$500/t |

- Brent +5.3% to $113.10 (Mar 19 AM) — driven by Ras Laffan second strike damage confirmation; +$5.72 on day.[64]
- Brent +6.1% to $109.75 intraday on Mar 18 (South Pars strike news); TTF European gas +9.1% same session.[42]
- Geopolitical risk premium: ~$40–45/bbl — "oil would be in the $40s without the Iran war."[50]
- Brent at $108.78 at 9:15 ET (Fortune, Mar 18); +$5.80 on day, +$41.18 from one month ago.[22]
- Citi (Mar 18): Brent to rally to $120 near-term; $130 avg Q2/Q3 in extended disruption scenario.[23]
- Goldman Sachs (Mar 18 revision): raised full-year 2026 Brent forecast; Q4 Brent $71, WTI $67 (assumes 21-day disruption + 30-day recovery — increasingly disconnected from facts on the ground given Day 20 with no ceasefire).[25] [34]
- US gasoline +32.6% in one month (AAA, Mar 19): $3.884/gal vs. $2.929 on Feb 19.[65]
- EU diesel: Germany, France, Italy, Netherlands, Finland all above EUR 2.00/L; Ireland highest at EUR 2.30/L; Spain largest jump at +27% to EUR 1.79/L.[46]

### GDP Sensitivity: Gulf Producers

| COUNTRY | GDP IMPACT | MECHANISM | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Qatar** | **−14%** | 100% LNG/oil exports through Hormuz; Ras Laffan force majeure; North Field delayed to 2027 | Goldman Sachs[34] |
| **Kuwait** | **−14%** | No pipeline bypass; 100% of 2.7 mb/d exports transit Hormuz; force majeure Mar 7 | Goldman Sachs[34] |
| **UAE** | **−5%** | ADCOP bypass partially offsets; Fujairah loading impaired; Mussafah terminal hit | Goldman Sachs[34] |
| **Saudi Arabia** | **−3%** | East-West pipeline partially offsets; Ras Tanura fire; ~2.0–2.5 mb/d production cut | Goldman Sachs[34] |

## LNG & Natural Gas Impact

| BENCHMARK | PRE-CRISIS | CURRENT | CHANGE |
|---|---|---|---|
| JKM (Asian LNG spot) | — | $19.27/MMBtu[33] | Elevated; outpacing Europe |
| TTF (European gas) | EUR 31.96/MWh | EUR 50.75/MWh[33] | +59% |
| TTF peak | — | EUR 59.57/MWh (Mar 10) | +86% |
| TTF (Mar 18 intraday) | — | +9.1% on South Pars strike news[42] | Accelerating |

- European gas jumped ~45% the day Qatar halted production at Ras Laffan (Mar 2).[33]
- Asian buyers aggressively competing for prompt cargoes, diverting from Europe; Asian LNG prices outpacing European gains.[33]
- Qatar **North Field expansion pushed to at least 2027** — long-term supply implications for ~20% of global LNG capacity.[33]
- South Pars phases 3–6 taken offline Mar 18 — South Pars accounts for 70–75% of Iranian gas production; also feeds petrochemical feedstock supply chains.[42] [47]
- Qatar's FM noted South Pars is "an extension of Qatar's North Field" — strike on Iranian side raises risks to shared reservoir pressure.[49]

## Petrochemical Cascade

- **Steam cracker physics:** Crackers operate at a minimum ~60% utilization or must shut down entirely — no idle mode. A cold shutdown requires 2+ months to restart, creating downstream disruptions that outlast the oil crisis itself. ~20% of Asian ethylene capacity is currently under force majeure.[44]
- **Asian naphtha dependency:** Over 60% of Asian naphtha is sourced from the Middle East — blocked Hormuz transit is simultaneously a crude shortage and a petrochemical feedstock crisis.[44]
- **LPG yield collapse:** When crude slates shift from light Gulf grades to heavier alternatives, LPG yield drops from ~2% to ~1% of feedstock — compounding the direct LPG shortage from blocked transit.
- **Feedstock cost spike:** Petrochemical feedstock costs up 15–25% globally; downstream impacts cascade through plastics, fertilizers, and pharmaceuticals.[44]
- **China exposure:** Over 80% of China's petrochemical capacity is configured for Iranian crude grades. Iran's continued Kharg + Jask exports partially mitigate this, but any escalation halting Iranian exports triggers immediate cracker shutdowns across China's industrial northeast.[44]
- **HSFO crack spread:** High-sulphur fuel oil (180 cst) widened +$20/bbl as bunker demand surges from longer rerouting distances. Cape route adds 10–14 days of fuel burn per voyage.[44]
- **European jet crack:** Jet fuel premium to ICE gasoil hit all-time record of $518.5/t — first time ever above $500/t.[43]

- **US LPG:** US produces 2.3 mb/d LPG with ~450K b/d spare export capacity. However, 5–6 week sailing time to Asia limits near-term relief — cargoes contracted today don't arrive until late April.[44]

## Insurance & Shipping

- **War risk premiums:** ~5% of vessel value per transit, up from 0.02–0.05% pre-crisis — a $100M tanker now costs $5M to insure for one transit.[41]
- Major P&I clubs (Gard, Skuld, NorthStandard, London P&I, American Club) cancelled war risk cover effective Mar 5.[41]
- Hormuz now the "world's most expensive waterway" after 300% premium surge.[31]
- Maersk, CMA CGM, Hapag-Lloyd all suspended Hormuz/Red Sea transits.[32]
- **Tanker stocks surging:** BWET +243% YTD; FRO +62.6%, NAT +63.2%, DHT +59.1%.[51]
- VLCC spot rates ~$170K/day.[32]
- **Container rerouting:** Cape of Good Hope diversion adds 10–14 days and $500–800K per voyage; ~250,000 containers/month diverted; ~70,000 vehicles/month from Japan/South Korea plants delayed.[29]
- **US LPG arbitrage window:** US Gulf Coast to Asian terminal = 5–6 week sailing. Cargoes contracted today arrive late April at earliest — limited near-term relief despite 450K b/d US spare export capacity.[44]

## Diplomatic & Military Developments

### Naval Coalition (Hormuz Escort)

- Trump called on NATO, China, Japan, South Korea, UK, and France to send warships to secure Hormuz.[15]
- **Declined:** Germany, Japan, Italy, Romania, Spain, UK, Australia, Luxembourg formally declined; EU voted against expanding naval operations.[15]
- **Partial:** France pledged 2 frigates ("purely defensive");[38] Pakistan launched Operation Muhafiz-ul-Bahr.
- US Navy estimates escort readiness by end of March — needs 8–10 destroyers per convoy.[38]
- Military analysts: forcing Hormuz open against IRGC asymmetric threats would be "almost suicidal" — requiring ~80,000 marines.[40]
- Trump threatened to reconsider NATO membership after allies refused to join Hormuz mission.[15]

### UN Security Council

- **Resolution 2817** (Mar 11): Condemned Iran's attacks on regional energy infrastructure. Vote: 13-0-2 (China/Russia abstained). Record 135 co-sponsors.[2]
- Competing Russian draft failed 4-2-9.

### Ceasefire: No Active Negotiations

- Iran FM Araghchi: "We never asked for a ceasefire."[6]
- Trump (Mar 15): Iran "willing" but "terms aren't good enough yet."[28]
- President Pezeshkian preconditions: recognition of rights, reparations, guarantees against future aggression.[28]

## Iran Leadership Succession

| ROLE | KILLED/REMOVED | SUCCESSOR | DATE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Supreme Leader | Ali Khamenei (Feb 28) | **Mojtaba Khamenei** (IRGC-backed)[58] | Elected Mar 9 |
| IRGC Commander | Mohammad Pakpour (Feb 28) | Ahmad Vahidi | Mar 1 |
| Security Chief | Ali Larijani (Mar 17)[16] | — | — |
| Basij Commander | Gholamreza Soleimani (Mar 17)[16] | — | — |
| Intelligence Minister | Esmaeil Khatib (Mar 18)[18] | — | Confirmed by President Pezeshkian |

**40+ Iranian officials killed total**, including intelligence minister Khatib (Mar 18).[16][18] Mojtaba Khamenei's election under IRGC pressure suggests the hardline faction has consolidated control — reducing the likelihood of near-term de-escalation.[39] IRGC has issued evacuation warnings for civilians near Saudi, Qatar, and UAE energy facilities, signaling imminent strikes beyond Iran's borders.[49]

## Flow Rate Constraints: Why "Paper" Relief Lags Physical Reality

SPR releases and pipeline activations are announced in volume terms. The binding constraint is **deployment rate** — how fast the barrels can physically move. Headline numbers consistently overstate near-term relief.[6]

### US Strategic Petroleum Reserve

**Theoretical 4.4 → Reality 1.2 mb/d**

The US SPR has never actually sustained its theoretical withdrawal rate. Salt cavern geology, pipeline infrastructure, and marine terminal throughput impose sequential bottlenecks that compress the effective rate to roughly one-quarter of the design maximum.[1]

| CONSTRAINT LAYER | RATE (MB/D) | NOTES |
|---|---|---|
| Salt cavern max withdrawal | 4.4 | Theoretical; never achieved simultaneously across all 4 sites[1] |
| Marine terminal throughput | 2.2 | Big Hill, Bryan Mound, West Hackberry combined loading capacity |
| Historical max achieved | 1.2 | Post-Katrina 2005 and Libya 2011 peaks; best real-world benchmark[1] |
| Current DOE plan (120 days) | 1.43 | 172M bbl ÷ 120 days; requires near-full terminal utilization[3] |

### IEA Non-US Members

Combined IEA non-US committed release: ~228M bbl across Europe, Japan, South Korea — but practical deployment rates are severely constrained by logistics, not storage.[1]

| REGION | COMMITTED (MB) | PRACTICAL RATE (MB/D) | BOTTLENECK |
|---|---|---|---|
| Europe (IEA) | ~150M | ~0.30 | Distributed storage across 28 countries; slow drawdown logistics[1] |
| Japan (IEA) | ~80M govt | ~0.20 | Tanker scheduling from coastal storage tanks |
| South Korea (IEA) | ~50M | ~0.10 | Pipeline connectivity limits throughput to domestic refineries |
| **Combined non-US IEA** | **~314M** | **~0.57** | Logistics — not storage — is the binding constraint |

### GL 134 Floating Inventory

| METRIC | FIGURE | NOTES |
|---|---|---|
| Total floating volume | 186M bbl | ~238 tankers; Sparta Commodities (Mar 16) |
| Near-field (India/China waters) | 60-70M bbl | Prompt delivery within days to nearby refineries |
| Effective discharge rate | ~2.0 mb/d tapering | Limited by port berths and unloading arms, not tanker availability |
| Expiration | Apr 11, 2026 | Stock depletes; no replenishment mechanism; one-time relief |

### Reality Check: Combined Maximum Deployment

**~6.5 mb/d Maximum → vs. −20 mb/d Lost**

If every mitigation deploys simultaneously at maximum physical rate: US SPR 1.43 + IEA non-US 0.57 + GL 134 2.0 + Saudi pipeline 1.75 + ADCOP 0.70 = **6.45 mb/d peak**. Against 20 mb/d lost, the physical deployment gap is ~13.5 mb/d even in a best-case coordination scenario. The paper balance sheet and the physical market diverge by the rate at which barrels can actually move.

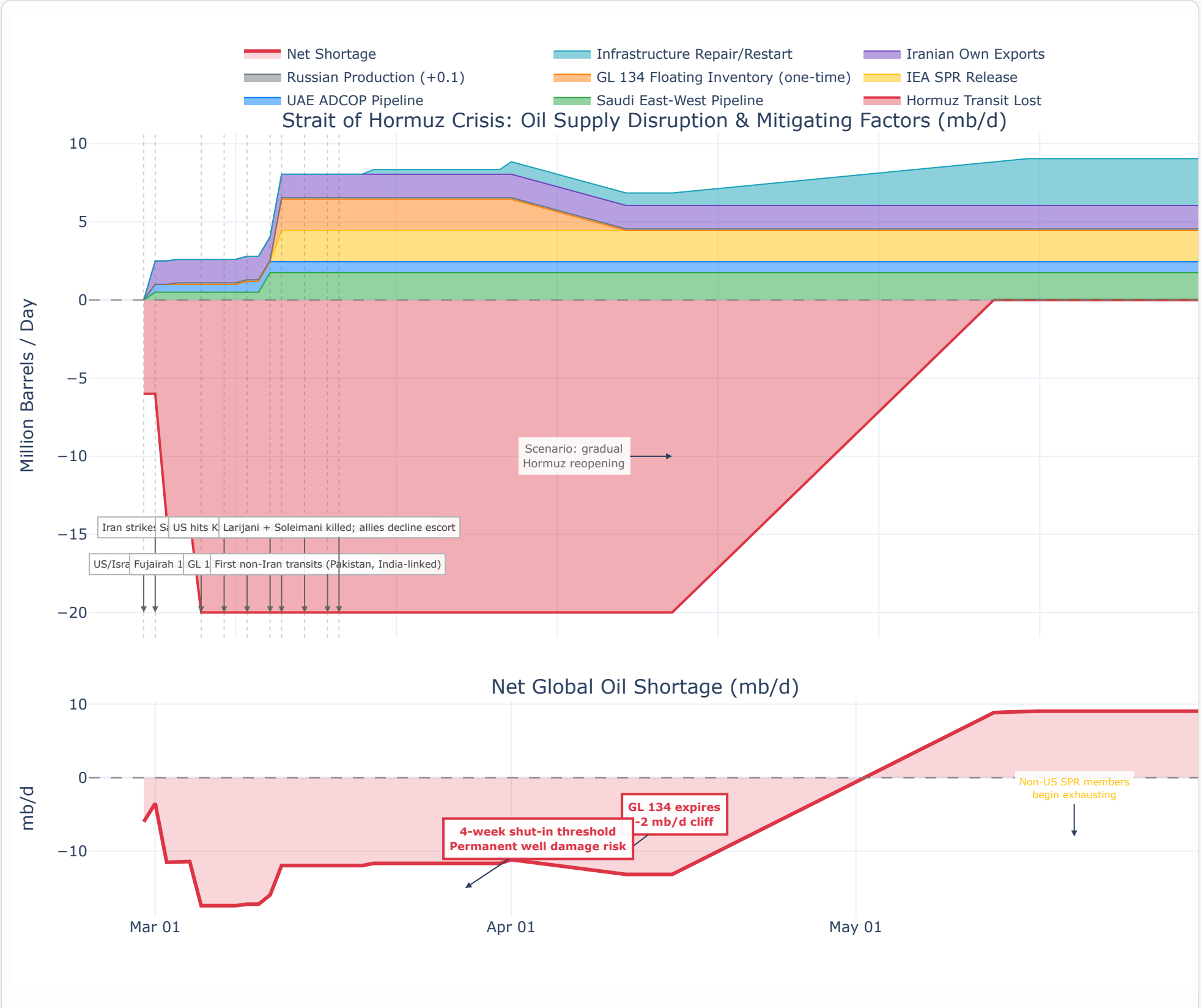
## Country-Level Vulnerability

Adjusted Days of Cover = Strategic Reserves ÷ (Daily Consumption × Hormuz Dependency %). Measures runway against the *Hormuz-disrupted portion* of supply specifically — more meaningful than headline days-of-supply figures.

Critical (<45 adj. days) High (45–100 adj. days) Moderate (100–200 adj. days) Low (direct exposure)

| COUNTRY | CONSUMPTION | HORMUZ DEP. | STRATEGIC RESERVES | ADJ. DAYS COVER | KEY VULNERABILITY |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Singapore** | ~1.5 mb/d (refinery) | >90% | <14 days | ~11 days | Regional refining hub; minimal strategic storage; choke point for SE Asia fuel |
| **India** | ~5.2 mb/d | ~60% | ~7 days govt | ~12 days | 87% import-dependent; secured limited passage; 30x spike in induction stove sales; ~37M bbl total govt reserves |
| **Australia** | ~1.0 mb/d | ~90% fuel imports | ~21 days | ~23 days | Lowest OECD compliance (IEA requires 90-day minimum); minimal domestic refining; worst-prepared OECD economy |
| **Japan** | ~3.2 mb/d | ~75% | 80M bbl govt SPR | ~33 days | PM warned of collapse within 8-9 months; declined escort coalition; refineries designed for Arab Light grade |
| **Taiwan** | ~1.0 mb/d | ~85% | ~60 days total | ~71 days | No domestic production; TSMC fab energy exposure; strategic ambiguity complicates supply agreements |
| **Thailand** | ~1.2 mb/d | ~55% | ~30 days total | ~55 days | Petrochemical complex at Map Ta Phut (7% of GDP) dependent on Gulf naphtha; limited bypass options |
| **South Korea** | ~2.8 mb/d | ~70% | ~90 days total | ~129 days | Refineries designed for Gulf crude; Ulsan complex processes Arab Heavy; issued "reduce by 20%" conservation guidance |
| **Kuwait** | ~0.5 mb/d (consumer) | 100% exports | — | GDP −14% | No pipeline bypass; 100% of 3.2 mb/d exports transit Hormuz; force majeure Mar 7; most GDP-exposed producer |
| **Pakistan** | ~0.6 mb/d | ~30% | ~20 days total | ~67 days | Iranian crude alternative available (pipeline under discussion); lower Hormuz exposure than neighbors; Operation Muhafiz-ul-Bahr |
| **Qatar** | ~0.7 mb/d (consumer) | 100% LNG exports | — | GDP −14% | Ras Laffan force majeure; North Field to 2027; 20% of global LNG offline; producer vulnerability (exports, not imports) |
| **Saudi Arabia** | ~4.0 mb/d | ~65% exports | — | GDP −3% | East-West pipeline partially offsets; Ras Tanura fire; ~2-2.5 mb/d cut; partial bypass mitigates worst case |
| **China** | ~16.5 mb/d | ~37% | ~1,200M bbl | ~197 days | Receiving Iranian crude via dark fleet; 75% rail electrified; 50% EV semi sales; in talks for guaranteed passage; most buffered major importer |
| **Europe (agg.)** | ~12 mb/d | ~12% oil / 20% LNG | 90+ days avg | >600 days | TTF gas +59%; Qatar LNG halt critical; North Field delay multi-year; oil exposure manageable but gas exposure severe |
| **UAE** | ~1.0 mb/d | <20% export exposure | — | GDP −5% | ADCOP pipeline reduces export Hormuz dependency; Fujairah struck 3x but loading continues; Mussafah terminal damaged |
| **United States** | ~20.0 mb/d | Net exporter | 415M bbl SPR | Indirect | No direct import exposure; indirect: allied economic collapse = global recession; export ban debate; SPR depleting |

## Interactive Supply Chart




## Demand Destruction Dynamics

- **Threshold price:** Bernstein estimates $155/bbl Brent as the level triggering structural demand destruction — ~50% above current levels. Below this, oil demand is largely inelastic in the short run due to lack of substitutes for transportation and industrial use.
- **Price elasticity:** Short-run oil demand elasticity: −0.2 to −0.3. At $103 Brent, implied demand reduction: ~2-3% globally (~2-3 mb/d). Meaningful, but far from closing the -12 mb/d structural gap.
- **IEA demand revisions:** IEA raised its 2026 demand destruction estimate from 210K b/d to 640K b/d — reflecting higher-than-expected price pass-through to consumers and faster behavioral response in Asia.
- **Asian emergency measures:** India mandating 10% ethanol blending expansion; Japan activating emergency conservation orders (factories, commercial buildings); South Korea issuing "reduce by 20%" public guidance; China restricting highway trucking to odd/even license plates in 7 provinces.
- **Stalemate scenario (15-20% demand drop):** If closure extends 3+ months with no resolution, IEA models 15-20% demand contraction in Asia-Pacific — triggering a global recession that itself destroys demand. This is the self-correcting mechanism, but the adjustment is severe and non-linear.
- **Supply-demand clearing:** Futures curve implies market expects clearing at ~$85 Brent by year-end (steep contango). Structural analysts (Pozsar, Trafigura) argue this assumes a brief disruption and is badly mispriced if closure extends past June.

## What to Watch

**1. 4-week shut-in threshold (~Mar 28):** Wells shut since Mar 3 approach permanent water coning damage window. Risk accelerates with every additional week.[7]

**2. GL 134 expiration (Apr 11):** −2 mb/d cliff drop from mitigation stack when 186M bbl floating inventory depletes. No extension signals. Single most predictable near-term price catalyst.[3] [13]

**3. IRGC retaliation on Gulf energy sites — one confirmed strike (Mar 18):** Five named targets (as of Mar 18 morning): SAMREF Yanbu (400K b/d), Sadara Jubail, Qatar Chemical, Ras Laffan refinery (305K b/d), Al-Hosn gasfield (1 bcf/d). Ras Laffan was hit that evening (ballistic missile strike, "extensive damage"). Remaining four targets still at risk. Any additional strike sends Brent to new highs.[49] [42] [61]

**4. South Pars damage assessment:** Phases 3–6 gas treatment facilities offline; Tehran refinery (220K b/d) hit. Qatar's FM noted South Pars is "an extension of Qatar's North Field" — strikes on shared reservoir risk multi-year supply implications beyond the war itself.[42] [49]

**5. Coalition escort formation:** US Navy estimates readiness by end of March (8–10 destroyers per convoy). Germany, Japan, Australia declined. Military analysts: "almost suicidal" without ~80,000 marines.[40] [38]

**6. Mojtaba Khamenei's posture:** IRGC-backed hardliner. Iran FM: "We never asked for a ceasefire." His stance determines whether closure is bargaining chip or long-term strategy.[6] [39]

**7. SPR drawdown pace:** US portion (172M bbl) gone by ~mid-July at 1.43 mb/d. Post-SPR cliff if crisis extends past summer.[1]

**8. Refined products crunch:** Bypass pipelines only move crude — no relief for diesel, LPG, or LNG. Diesel $4.95/gal. EU diesel EUR 2.00+/L. Ras Laffan + North Field delay = 20% of global LNG supply impacted for years.[12] [46]

**9. Yuan-denominated Hormuz transit:** If Iran allows yuan-settled cargoes, it's a structural shift in petrodollar dynamics. Watch China-Iran negotiations.[26]

**10. Insurance normalization:** War risk at 5% of hull value makes commercial transit economically unviable even if militarily possible.[41] [31]

**11. Mine deployment threat:** IRGC has not yet deployed sea mines — widely considered the red line that triggers direct US military escalation. Any confirmed mine detection = immediate $20–30/bbl market shock. Watch USNI and CENTCOM.[40]

**12. Xi-Trump back-channel:** China absorbs 37% of Hormuz crude flows and is the only actor with credible leverage over Iran. A Xi-Trump bilateral call is the most likely catalyst for a ceasefire framework.[39]

**13. Qatar diplomatic break with Iran (Mar 19):** Qatar's expulsion of Iranian military attachés signals a shift from ambivalent Gulf state to active adversary. Qatar hosts the largest US air base in the region (Al Udeid). Watch for: Qatar joining the escort coalition, freezing bilateral energy agreements with Iran, or providing basing support for expanded US strikes.[63]

## Market & Social Intelligence

### Sparta Commodities (Physical Market Intelligence)

- **Neil Crosby, Head of Research:** *"Brent is too low. Prices will grind higher the longer this conflict continues. Physical markets still haven't fully priced medium-term disruption — each week should see further repricing."*[85]
- **Philip Jones-Lux, Sparta:** *"This is the most important oil supply disruption event since the 1970s."*[85]
- **Jet fuel at 10-year high** (Sparta data cited by AGBI): jet cannot be blended like diesel; Gulf crude is the optimal feedstock; Hormuz disruption hits jet supply disproportionately. Approximately 1/5 of global jet exports transited Hormuz pre-war.[85]
- **Products more stressed than crude** (Sparta): refined products margins have widened far more than crude differentials — refiners outside the Gulf are the indirect beneficiaries.
- Track real-time Sparta analysis: @JuneGoh_Sparta on X

### Fintwit / X Sentiment

- **Consensus long energy.** BWET ~+470% YTD. USO +64%. XLE +27%. Record $211M retail inflows on Mar 12.[13]
- **Iran's selective blockade** widely discussed as strategically effective — divides Western coalition.
- **"Stalemate at sea"** framing gaining traction. Ritter analysis: reopening requires ~80,000 marines.[38]
- Relief rallies treated as **"sell the rip"** — not genuine de-escalation.
- Goldman: $100+ March, $85 April. UBS: $90 June, $85 year-end.[32]

### Reddit (WSB, r/investing, r/stocks)

- **"Oil is the new meme stock."** USO largest single-day inflow since Aug 2020. CNBC: "meme-style" trading.[13]
- **SPY sentiment still bullish (68/100)** — WSB shorting VIX, betting crisis contained.
- **USO contango warnings** from experienced traders: "Don't confuse an oil trade with an oil investment."
- **Futures curve disconnect:** Jan 2027 Brent ~$70. Retail more bullish than curve implies.
- **Second-order plays:** Defense, tankers, Asian refiners. "Alpha is in second-order effects."

### HackerNews Technical

- **Escort infeasibility:** Iran's asymmetric threats in confined waters make convoy escort untenable without massive amphibious deployment.[52]
- **Refinery grade mismatch:** Can't swap crude sources without retooling — constrains substitution speed.
- **Water coning:** Under-discussed mechanism behind 4-week well damage threshold.[53]
- **No shale response at $100:** "Wall Street killed the wildcatters" — capital discipline = buybacks over capex.[53]
- **Pozsar's Bretton Woods III:** Hormuz as structural validation of physical commodity repricing.[52]
- **China's resilience:** 75% rail electrified, 50% of 2025 semi-tractor sales electric, Russian gas via pipelines.
- **Silicon Valley gasoline at $7+/gal** (reported @Animats).[52]

### YouTube Coverage

- **Peter Zeihan** most prolific — rapid-fire series since Feb 28. Also on Prof G Pod with Galloway (Mar 9).[51]
- **Al Jazeera Inside Story** (Mar 16): panel on Hormuz as Trump's problem. Military analyst: "almost suicidal."

- **Key thesis:** US doesn't need Gulf oil (net exporter) but allies do — strait closure accelerates deglobalization.

### Trading Signals

| SIGNAL | BULL CASE | BEAR CASE |
|---|---|---|
| Futures curve LIVE | Backwardation = expects short disruption | If wrong, violent catch-up repricing |
| Retail inflows ($211M)[13] | Momentum extends rally | Meme-style = fragile, reverses fast |
| Shale non-response | No new supply = sustained shortage | Discipline could break at $130+ |
| Tankers (BWET ~+470%) LIVE | Longer routes for months | Snap back on ceasefire signal |
| SPR drawdown POLICY | Buys 120-200 days | Post-SPR cliff past Jul |
| GL 134 (Apr 11) POLICY | Extension = more supply | No extension = -2 mb/d cliff |
| Clean energy flat | Not pricing structural shift | Could catch bid at 3-month mark |
| Insurance (5% hull) LIVE | Commercial transit dead | Normalization = de-escalation signal |

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- **[68]** CNBC: Iran attack wipes out 17% of Qatar's LNG capacity for up to five years — QatarEnergy CEO; 12.8 MTPA offline, $20B annual revenue lost (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[69]** The National: Shah Gas Field (ADNOC/Occidental) set ablaze by drones — 1.28 bcf/d offline, ~20% of UAE gas, ~5% of global sulphur (Mar 16–17, 2026) ↑
- **[70]** Bloomberg: UAE says drone attack causes fire at Ruwais complex; 922K bpd refinery halted (Mar 10, 2026) ↑
- **[71]** Euronews: Bapco declares force majeure as Iran sets Bahrain's only refinery ablaze — 405K bpd, 32 civilians injured (Mar 9, 2026) ↑
- **[72]** BOE Report: SAMREF (Saudi Aramco/ExxonMobil JV) in Yanbu targeted by Iran — minimal damage reported (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[73]** Arab Times: Drone attack sparks minor fire at Kuwait's Mina Al-Ahmadi refinery; 730K bpd capacity affected (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[74]** Al Jazeera: Shell declares force majeure on LNG contracts from Qatar — covering EU, South Korea, and China buyers (Mar 11, 2026) ↑
- **[75]** CNBC: Oil briefly hits $119/bbl as Iran strikes Qatar LNG facility; supply worries drive intraday spike (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[76]** Al Jazeera: Could oil hit $200 a barrel? Analysts no longer think it's far-fetched (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[77]** Gasworld: Three attacks on Qatar energy sites as Gulf crisis escalates — Mar 2 drones, Mar 18 PM Pearl GTL, Mar 19 AM LNG trains (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[78]** CNBC/Reuters: Iran attack wipes out 17% of Qatar's LNG capacity; QatarEnergy CEO Saad al-Kaabi statement (Mar 19, 2026) ↑

- **[79]** BNN Bloomberg: Iran attack wipes out 17% of Qatar's LNG capacity for up to five years — QatarEnergy CEO (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[80]** Jerusalem Post / Defense Post: IDF strikes Bandar Anzali (Caspian Sea) — 4 missile ships, 1 corvette, Iranian Navy command center destroyed; first Israeli strike on northern Iran, first hit on Iran–Russia resupply lifeline (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[81]** CNBC: Trump threatens to "massively blow up" South Pars if Iran attacks Qatar; tells Netanyahu to halt gas field strikes (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[82]** Axios: US and Israel coordinated South Pars strike in advance; Trump's public denial was false — confirmed by US Defense official and two senior Israeli officials (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[83]** NBC News: Iran FM Araghchi — "We have sent no message and have not requested a ceasefire" (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[84]** CNN Day 20 wrap: 200+ Israeli targets struck across western/central Iran on Mar 18; 20+ maritime incidents total in Hormuz/Gulf since Feb 28 (Mar 19, 2026) ↑
- **[85]** AGBI citing Sparta Commodities: Neil Crosby (Head of Research) and Philip Jones-Lux analyst quotes; jet fuel at 10-year high; products more stressed than crude; Brent "too low" and will grind higher (Mar 19, 2026) ↑